

binary computer to be developed, which happened almost a hundred years after.

You see examples of Boolean algebra all the time: the NOT and OR operators in Google, “NAND” as in “NAND Flash device,” and so on. But it runs much, much deeper.

So what is Boolean algebra? Very simply put, it’s the familiar AND, NOT, etc. that you’re familiar with—1 AND 0 equals 0, 1 OR 0 equals 1, 1 XOR 1 equals 0, and so on. “Truth tables” is the term most commonly used in conjunction with these: for example, the truth table for the XOR operation goes thus:



George Boole’s system laid the foundation for the computers to come

This	XOR	This Equals
0	0	0
0	1	1
1	0	1
1	1	0

Such operations are essential to logic circuit design, which are essential to higher-level building blocks like integrated circuits.

For a very basic introduction to Boolean algebra, refer <http://tinyurl.com/2sknk4>

For a complete discussion of why Boolean algebra is fundamental to the development of computers, refer <http://tinyurl.com/2tfhbn>